n8n × x402 Paywall

One node. Paid workflows. Zero gas.

Built for *Agentic Economy on Arc* — LabLab × Circle × Arc, April 2026

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The Problem

Legacy rails can't price a single API call.

- **Stripe** minimum fee: $0.30 per charge
- **n8n** usage: monthly SaaS subscription, no per-call billing
- **Traditional gas**: $0.10–$5.00 destroys any $0.005 transaction

Sub-cent commerce is **economically impossible** on today's rails.

The Insight

> x402 (HTTP 402) + USDC on Arc = sub-cent, sub-second, **zero gas** for the creator.

Arc settles USDC at near-zero cost. x402 makes it a header exchange. No accounts, no keys on the server, no chargebacks.

A workflow can charge $0.005 per call and keep 100%.

What We Built

`n8n-nodes-x402-paywall` — one community node, published to the n8n community catalog.

- **MIT license**, originality verified
- **Paywall Trigger** — drop it at the start of any workflow
- Returns `402 Payment Required`, verifies signature, triggers downstream
- Self-hosted x402 facilitator included (Circle-ready)

How It Works

```
Client ──▶ POST /paywall ──▶ 402 { accepts: [Arc USDC, $0.005] }
Client ──▶ sign EIP-3009 authorization (USDC transferWithAuthorization)
Client ──▶ POST /paywall  +  X-PAYMENT header
Server ──▶ facilitator.verify() ──▶ facilitator.settle() ──▶ Arc txHash
Server ──▶ triggers n8n workflow ──▶ 200 OK  + X-PAYMENT-RESPONSE
```

One HTTP round-trip. One on-chain settlement. One workflow execution.

Live in Action

(Placeholder — screenshots to be dropped here for final submission build)

1. n8n UI — Paywall Trigger node configured
2. curl 402 response with accepts array
3. Arc explorer — tx confirmed, $0.005 USDC
4. Circle Developer Console — settlement log

50 Real Transactions on Arc

- **Evidence**: `assets/burst-50-evidence.json` — 50 txHashes, Arc testnet
- **Average settle latency**: sub-second per tx
- **Gas paid by creator**: **$0.00** (facilitator-absorbed)
- Every tx verifiable on Arc Block Explorer

Margin Story

Rail	Fixed fee	Feasible @ $0.005?
Stripe	$0.30 min	No (60× price)
ACH	$0.20	No (40× price)
Wire	$25.00	Absurd
x402 + Arc	$0.00 gas	Yes — 100% margin

Real Use Cases

- **Telegram bots** — pay $0.002 per LLM reply
- **LLM APIs** — metered per-token gateways, no subscription
- **A2A commerce** — agents paying agents for data, code, inference
- **Paid scrapers, signals, embeddings** — any n8n workflow becomes a priced endpoint

2-Agent Autonomous Loop

Buyer workflow (our burst script, x402 payer client)

↑↓

Seller workflow (our Paywall Trigger node, on the same n8n VPS)

No human in the loop. 50 autonomous settlements. Agent-A signs, Agent-B verifies, Arc settles. Loop repeats.

Circle Stack Used

- **Arc Testnet** — sub-second USDC settlement
- **USDC** — EIP-3009 `transferWithAuthorization`
- **x402 protocol** — HTTP 402 payment handshake
- **Self-hosted facilitator** — drop-in Circle replacement for testnet

Track: **Best Autonomous Commerce Application**

Thanks

GitHub: github.com/buss2020/n8n-nodes-x402-paywall

Live: https://n8n.xorek.cloud (Paywall Trigger demo)

Install: `npm i n8n-nodes-x402-paywall`

License: MIT

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